

Data Analytics and Business Intelligence English Jargon Quick Reference

Field-specific terms, contrast pairs, and high-pressure sentence frames

Audience: data analysts, BI developers, analytics engineers, data scientists, reporting teams, business analysts, and data-driven managers

Focus: A data analytics and BI English curriculum for metric definitions, dashboards, data quality, stakeholder requests, causation, experimentation, governance, and insight presentation.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

Metric Definitions and Business Questions

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
metric	In data analytics and business intelligence, metric is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to clarify what a number means before reporting it.	clarify metric; document metric	Contrast: metric should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify metric and the evidence that supports it.
business definition	In data analytics and business intelligence, business definition is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to clarify what a number means before reporting it.	clarify business definition; document business definition	Contrast: business definition should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify business definition and the evidence that supports it.
source of truth	In data analytics and business intelligence, source of truth is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to clarify what a number means before reporting it.	clarify source of truth; document source of truth	Contrast: source of truth should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify source of truth and the evidence that supports it.
owner	Named person or role accountable for a decision, action, deliverable, or risk.	clarify owner; document owner	Contrast: owner should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify owner and the evidence that supports it.

Data Quality and Trust

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
data quality	In data analytics and business intelligence, data quality is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to discuss data problems without undermining the whole analysis.	clarify data quality; document data quality	Contrast: data quality should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify data quality and the evidence that supports it.
freshness	In data analytics and business intelligence, freshness is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss data problems without undermining the whole analysis.	clarify freshness; document freshness	Contrast: freshness should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify freshness and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
completeness	In data analytics and business intelligence, completeness is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss data problems without undermining the whole analysis.	clarify completeness; document completeness	Contrast: completeness should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify completeness and the evidence that supports it.
pipeline	In data analytics and business intelligence, pipeline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss data problems without undermining the whole analysis.	clarify pipeline; document pipeline	Contrast: pipeline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify pipeline and the evidence that supports it.

Dashboards and Executive Reporting

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
dashboard	Visual summary of selected measures used to monitor status, performance, or risk.	clarify dashboard; document dashboard	Contrast: dashboard should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify dashboard and the evidence that supports it.
KPI	Key performance indicator used to monitor progress against an important objective.	track KPI; explain a change in KPI	Contrast: KPI measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track KPI by segment and explain what changed.
threshold	In data analytics and business intelligence, threshold is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to design dashboards around decisions, not decoration.	clarify threshold; document threshold	Contrast: threshold should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify threshold and the evidence that supports it.
drill-down	In data analytics and business intelligence, drill-down is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to design dashboards around decisions, not decoration.	clarify drill-down; document drill-down	Contrast: drill-down should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify drill-down and the evidence that supports it.

Causation, Correlation, and Caveats

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
correlation	In data analytics and business intelligence, correlation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent overinterpretation of patterns.	clarify correlation; document correlation	Contrast: correlation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify correlation and the evidence that supports it.
causation	In data analytics and business intelligence, causation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent overinterpretation of patterns.	clarify causation; document causation	Contrast: causation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify causation and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
confounder	In data analytics and business intelligence, confounder is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent overinterpretation of patterns.	clarify confounder; document confounder	Contrast: confounder should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify confounder and the evidence that supports it.
selection bias	In data analytics and business intelligence, selection bias is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to prevent overinterpretation of patterns.	clarify selection bias; document selection bias	Contrast: selection bias should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify selection bias and the evidence that supports it.

SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
SQL	In data analytics and business intelligence, SQL is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain technical logic to nontechnical partners.	clarify SQL; document SQL	Contrast: SQL should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify SQL and the evidence that supports it.
data model	In data analytics and business intelligence, data model is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to explain technical logic to nontechnical partners.	clarify data model; document data model	Contrast: data model should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify data model and the evidence that supports it.
grain	In data analytics and business intelligence, grain is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to explain technical logic to nontechnical partners.	clarify grain; document grain	Contrast: grain should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify grain and the evidence that supports it.
join logic	In data analytics and business intelligence, join logic is information that can be checked to support a claim, decision, investigation, or compliance conclusion. Use it when teams need to explain technical logic to nontechnical partners.	clarify join logic; document join logic	Contrast: join logic should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify join logic and the evidence that supports it.

Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
sample size	In data analytics and business intelligence, sample size is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to present test results with practical and statistical context.	clarify sample size; document sample size	Contrast: sample size should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify sample size and the evidence that supports it.

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
effect size	In data analytics and business intelligence, effect size is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to present test results with practical and statistical context.	clarify effect size; document effect size	Contrast: effect size should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify effect size and the evidence that supports it.
confidence interval	In data analytics and business intelligence, confidence interval is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to present test results with practical and statistical context.	clarify confidence interval; document confidence interval	Contrast: confidence interval should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify confidence interval and the evidence that supports it.
guardrail	In data analytics and business intelligence, guardrail is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to present test results with practical and statistical context.	clarify guardrail; document guardrail	Contrast: guardrail should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify guardrail and the evidence that supports it.

Data Governance and Privacy

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
data governance	In data analytics and business intelligence, data governance is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to set data-use boundaries professionally.	clarify data governance; document data governance	Contrast: data governance should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify data governance and the evidence that supports it.
privacy	In data analytics and business intelligence, privacy is a performance or governance dimension that must be protected through defined evidence, thresholds, and accountability. Use it when teams need to set data-use boundaries professionally.	clarify privacy; document privacy	Contrast: privacy should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify privacy and the evidence that supports it.
access control	In data analytics and business intelligence, access control is a repeatable control mechanism used to prevent, detect, or confirm conditions before work proceeds. Use it when teams need to set data-use boundaries professionally.	clarify access control; document access control	Contrast: access control should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify access control and the evidence that supports it.
retention	In data analytics and business intelligence, retention is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to set data-use boundaries professionally.	clarify retention; document retention	Contrast: retention should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify retention and the evidence that supports it.

Insight Storytelling and Recommendations

Term	Working meaning	Collocations	Contrast and workplace line
insight	In data analytics and business intelligence, insight is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to move from analysis to action without overstating certainty.	clarify insight; document insight	Contrast: insight should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify insight and the evidence that supports it.
recommendation	In data analytics and business intelligence, recommendation is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to move from analysis to action without overstating certainty.	clarify recommendation; document recommendation	Contrast: recommendation should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify recommendation and the evidence that supports it.
assumption	In data analytics and business intelligence, assumption is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to move from analysis to action without overstating certainty.	clarify assumption; document assumption	Contrast: assumption should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify assumption and the evidence that supports it.
next best action	In data analytics and business intelligence, next best action is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to move from analysis to action without overstating certainty.	clarify next best action; document next best action	Contrast: next best action should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify next best action and the evidence that supports it.

Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

Situation	Useful language
Metric Definitions and Business Questions	Before we commit, I want to confirm metric, business definition, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If business definition, source table, filter logic, and owner need agreement., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Data Quality and Trust	Before we commit, I want to confirm data quality, freshness, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If freshness, completeness, transformation logic, and upstream changes must be checked., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Dashboards and Executive Reporting	Before we commit, I want to confirm dashboard, KPI, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If audience, decision, refresh cadence, and alert thresholds need focus., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Causation, Correlation, and Caveats	Before we commit, I want to confirm correlation, causation, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If seasonality, selection bias, control groups, and other factors need analysis., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
SQL, Models, and Transformation Logic	Before we commit, I want to confirm SQL, data model, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If join logic, grain, filters, and reconciliation need transparent review., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Experiment Readouts and Statistical Thinking	Before we commit, I want to confirm sample size, effect size, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If sample size, effect size, confidence, guardrails, and cost should guide decisions., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.
Data Governance and Privacy	Before we commit, I want to confirm data governance, privacy, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If purpose limitation, access control, retention, and privacy rules need confirmation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

Situation	Useful language
Insight Storytelling and Recommendations	Before we commit, I want to confirm insight, recommendation, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If uncertainty, tradeoffs, assumptions, and next tests need visible framing., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.

High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

Contrast Pairs

Do not confuse	Useful distinction
metric vs owner	In metric definitions and business questions, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
data quality vs pipeline	In data quality and trust, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
dashboard vs drill-down	In dashboards and executive reporting, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
correlation vs selection bias	In causation, correlation, and caveats, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
SQL vs join logic	In sql, models, and transformation logic, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
sample size vs guardrail	In experiment readouts and statistical thinking, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
data governance vs retention	In data governance and privacy, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.
insight vs next best action	In insight storytelling and recommendations, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.